

YILAN ANNIE GAO

PMP · CSM · M.Ed. · M.P.I. · Bilingual English & Mandarin

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- Program manager and community builder with 12 years of experience designing and scaling engagement programs across university campuses, developer ecosystems, and international markets.
- Built Roblox China's first-ever game jam from scratch — recruiting student participants, partnering directly with faculty and student organizations, and incubating several of Roblox China's top developers from that cohort.
- Additional campus engagement roots from 7 years in higher education, managing institutional partnerships, international student programs, and cross-departmental initiatives.
- Experienced operating in ambiguous, fast-moving environments with significant autonomy.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Program Manager, Developer Relations Feb 2023 – Present

Roblox Corporation | San Mateo, CA

Developer Community Programs (2025–Present)

- Serve as primary cross-functional POC for the platform's Top creators, managing community relationship strategy and representing developer interests in negotiations with Engineering, Policy, Legal, and Moderation teams at VP and C-level.
- Built the moderation escalation system for top creators, defining community escalation workflows, cross-functional process, and communication strategy, directly reducing unnecessary content takedowns affecting platform engagement.
- Drive GTM launch of an IP protection product, onboarding the platform's top developer teams through phased rollout and iterative community feedback loops.
- Manage a team of 3 direct reports; resolved 600+ community support escalations in Q1 2025, synthesizing insights into operational improvements and product roadmap input.

Platform Events & Community Programming (2024)

- Produced and project-managed 5 platform-wide community events each reaching 10M+ players; owned full lifecycle from participant planning through live execution, managing all external vendors and contractors.
- Synthesized real-time and post-event community analytics into executive-ready insights, translating engagement data into program recommendations for subsequent events.

International Community Development — China, Japan & LatAm (2023)

- Managed developer community programs in Asia and US, localized onboarding, partner communications, and engagement strategies tailored to each market; represented Roblox at international developer conferences in Mexico.
- Co-designed a structured developer feedback system embedding community insights into the global product development cycle, ensuring international developer perspectives shaped product decisions upstream.

Senior Program Manager, Developer Relations Mar 2021 – Feb 2023

Roblox China | Shenzhen, China

Campus Engagement & Student Community Programs

- Designed and executed Roblox China's first-ever Game Jam — conceptualizing the program from scratch, collaborating with faculty, student organizations, and external brand partners, and managing end-to-end logistics, judging, and mentorship; the program directly incubated several of China's top Roblox developers.

- Managed campus partnerships across 10+ universities in China, delivering student workshop, advising student clubs on game development with Roblox, and establishing a pipeline from student engagement to active developer community membership.
- Collaborated with university faculty and department heads to embed Roblox platform education into campus programming, developing materials and workshops tailored to student audiences.

Strategy & Operations

- Served as strategy and operations partner reporting to the VP of DevRel China, synthesizing developer ecosystem trends, campus program outcomes, and market data into executive briefings that influenced Global HQ investment decisions.
- Defined GTM strategy for China platform launch; structured ambiguous local developer and compliance needs into prioritized recommendations for global engineering teams.

Partnership Programs Lead Apr 2019 – Apr 2021

California State University, San Bernardino | San Bernardino, CA

- Managed a portfolio of institutional partnerships with universities and organizations, achieving 60% recruitment growth in year one and 100% program renewal rate through proactive relationship management.
- Designed and delivered 4 end-to-end recurring programs totaling 130+ instructional hours, managing budgets exceeding \$4M USD and coordinating cross-functional teams across the institution.
- Led cross-functional strategic design initiatives resulting in 23% improvement in participant engagement and learning effectiveness.

China Programs Coordinator Jul 2014 – Mar 2019

Virginia Commonwealth University | Richmond, VA

- Led international student recruitment strategy achieving 300% enrollment growth; developed and managed 5 new signature international education programs bridging students across US and China.
- Served as primary liaison across 10+ campus departments and 20+ partner institutions in China, coordinating multi-stakeholder relationships and delivering training and reporting to university partners and leadership.

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Community & Program Management: Ambassador program design · Campus engagement · Hackathon & event programming · Community onboarding · Developer relations · Student outreach

Strategy & Operations: GTM strategy · Program roadmapping · Multi-stakeholder management · Cross-functional alignment · Executive communication · Process design from scratch

Domain Knowledge: University/campus partnerships · Developer ecosystems · International market programs · Compliance & policy strategy · Event management

Technical: SQL · Tableau · Excel · Flourish · Jira · Confluence · AI tools (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini)

Languages: English · Mandarin Chinese

Certifications: Project Management Professional (PMP), PMI · Certified Scrum Master (CSM) · Business Analytics & Data Visualization

EDUCATION

Master of Product Innovation Dec 2018

Virginia Commonwealth University | Richmond, VA

Master of Education — Adult Learning & Human Resource Development May 2014

Virginia Commonwealth University | Richmond, VA

Bachelor of Arts — English & International Relations Jul 2012

Sichuan International Studies University | Chongqing, China